



Toronto College[™]
of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries^{inc.}

Sexual Violence Policy

Last updated January 2026

Sexual Violence Policy

The Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. takes sexual violence very seriously.

According to the Ontario Career Colleges Act, 2005, “sexual violence” means any sexual act or act targeting a person's sexuality, gender identity or gender expression, whether the act is physical or psychological in nature, that is committed, threatened or attempted against a person without the person's consent, and includes sexual assault, sexual harassment, stalking, indecent exposure, voyeurism and sexual exploitation. 2016, c. 2, Sched. 5, s. 1.

No person shall commit, attempt or threaten an act of sexual violence against any other person. This includes, but is not limited to, sexual assault, sexual harassment, stalking, indecent exposure, voyeurism, degrading sexual imagery, verbal harassment of a sexual nature, distribution of sexual images or video without consent, cyber harassment, cyber stalking or an act targeting a person's sexuality, gender identity or gender expression.

Sexual Violence Support

The Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. provides training/information about sexual violence to all students and staff members and offers support for staff and students who have been affected by sexual violence.

Students can access information about the school's counsellor (Counselling@toronto-college-dental.org), the Assaulted Women's Health line (<https://www.awhl.org/contact-us>), Support Services for Male Survivors of Sexual Abuse (<https://www.centralhealthline.ca/printService.aspx?id=167553>), the Barbra Schlifer Commemorative Clinic (women only - <http://schliferclinic.com/>) and It's Never Okay (an Action Plan to Stop Sexual Violence and Harassment- <https://www.ontario.ca/files/2025-02/actionplan-itsneverokay.pdf>- on the student portal under “Health and Safety Resources”).

All students have a right to feel safe in their learning environment and thus should become familiar with the resources available to them and encourage other students to learn more about sexual violence and sexual violence prevention.

Students who are affected by sexual violence will be appropriately accommodated.

Last updated January 2026

Students are not required to make a formal report to access the services of the College's counsellor.

Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. (TCDHA) prioritizes the safety of our students and has a zero-tolerance for Sexual Misconduct. All employee's of TCDHA have signed a Sexual Misconduct Policy understanding what constitutes as Sexual Misconduct and the resulting consequences for committing these acts. The Information in this policy is derived from the *Strengthening Postsecondary Institutions and Students Act, 2022*.

Reporting Procedure

In the event that a student feels that he or she was a victim of sexual violence, we encourage the student to report it immediately. All incidents or complaints of sexual violence will be investigated by the college. If the sexual violence is unrelated to TCDHA and occurred in the students personal life, TCDHA will still meet with the student to discuss accommodation and resources.

1. Reporting of sexual violence can be done in person or by email to the Business Director (email: BusinessDirector@toronto-college-dental.org) or to the Branch Manager (BranchManager@toronto-college-dental.org).
2. The school will respond to any reports of sexual violence within 10 business days and all information will be kept confidential where legally acceptable. If an incident of sexual violence is reported, a meeting will be scheduled with the Complainant to discuss the incident and look for ways of resolving the situation.
3. A meeting will be held with the Business Director and Branch Manager to discuss the incident. During this meeting a Sexual Violence Report will be filled out. At the discretion of the Complainant, this report can be done anonymously. These meetings will be recorded and all evidence such as video, social media, screenshots etc., will be collected. If it's determined that a crime may have been committed, the appropriate authorities will be called. A party to an investigation or decision-making process has the right to have a person present with him or her at every stage of the process. TCDHA will provide the Complainant with possible supports, services and accommodations when they make their report.

4. The Business Director and Branch Manager will address the allegations made against a faculty, staff or student of the college (separately from the complainant). These meetings will be recorded and all evidence such as video, social media, screenshots etc. will be collected. A party to an investigation or decision-making process has the right to have a person present with him or her at every stage of the process. However, if the allegations are not against a TCDHA member, TCDHA will encourage the student to seek legal support and will provide them with accommodation, support and resources.

5. Interim measures may include:

- Ban from TCDHA property
- Removal from residence
- Suspension from study or employment

*Interim measures do not represent a finding of misconduct

6. Produce a written investigation report.

TCDHA will make every effort to protect the confidentiality of those who are affected by sexual violence while also managing the legal and risk management to provide a safe learning environment for all students.

This means that Complainants must be aware that in order to act in procedural fairness, information will be shared with the respondent to investigate and resolve complaints.

TCDHA may also discuss information if there is a risk to the health and safety of other students, clients or employees.

Other departments may be included in the investigation process if the complaint is against a faculty or staff member, if the person is a witness to the case or the CEO if the incident has occurred onsite within the facility. This may include the Program Director (if the incident involves a faculty member), CEO and/or 1st/2nd year Educational Director (if the incident involves another student).

Students are not required to report an incident of, or make a complaint about sexual violence if they chose not to. A victim may choose not to request an investigation by the career college and has the right not to participate in any investigation that may occur. In the event that a student feels that he or she was a victim of sexual violence, but does not wish to report the incident, we

Last updated January 2026

encourage the student to contact the Toronto College of Dental Hygiene and Auxiliaries Inc. Counsellor.

If students, in good faith, report an incident of, or make a complaint about, sexual violence, they will not be subject to discipline or sanctions for violations of the career college's policies relating to drug or alcohol use at the time the alleged sexual violence occurred.

Complainants who disclose their experience of sexual violence through reporting an incident of, making a complaint about, or accessing supports and services for sexual violence, will not be asked irrelevant questions during the investigation process by the career college's staff or investigators, including irrelevant questions relating to the student's sexual expression or past sexual history.

Action

When considering which action to take in the event of a sexual violence incident, the college will consider the evidence and nature of the incident.

Actions may include:

- Verbal or written apologies
- Suspension or expulsion from the college
- A referral to counselling
- Termination of employment
- Referral to police or other legal authorities

Appeal

Any party involved in a sexual violence incident may appeal the decision made by the college. All appeals must be made in writing to the Dean of Students within 30 days. The Dean of Students will review the evidence, and may ask to meet with parties involved to gather more information. Any meeting with the Dean of Students will be fully documented. During these meetings all parties are allowed to bring a third party as a witness.